

Vladimir Putin and Bashar al-Assad held talks in Moscow

Syrian President Bashar al-Assad paid an unannounced visit to Moscow. During the talks, the two sides discussed a wide range of political and humanitarian issues.

YEREVAN, September 14 — Sputnik. Russian and Syrian Presidents Vladimir Putin and Bashar al-Assad met in Moscow yesterday, the Kremlin press service **reported on Tuesday.**



More than 400 militants have laid down their arms in southern Syria, according to media reports.

September 6, 2021, 9:52 PM

The talks were reportedly held in the Kremlin. The Syrian president arrived in Russia on an unannounced visit.

During the meeting, the Russian leader congratulated Assad on the results of the presidential elections in Syria.

"The results show that people trust you and, despite all the difficulties and tragedies of previous years, they still associate you with the process of recovery and return to normal life," Putin emphasized.

In addition, the Russian head of state assessed how his colleague is managing dialogue with opponents.

"I know you're doing a lot, including to establish dialogue with your political opponents. I sincerely hope that this process will continue. Only the consolidation of all forces in Syria will allow the country to get back on its feet and begin progressive development and forward movement," Putin said.

At the same time, he expressed confidence that the country's consolidation is being hampered by the illegal presence of foreign armed forces in Syria.

"The main problem, in my opinion, is that foreign armed forces are present in certain parts of the country without a UN decision, without your sanctions, which clearly violates international law and prevents you from making the maximum effort to consolidate the country and move toward its recovery at the pace that would be possible if the entire territory were controlled by a legitimate government," Putin said.

He also drew attention to the fact that militants continue to operate in Syria. "Unfortunately, pockets of resistance still remain, led by terrorists who not only control some part of the territory but also continue to terrorize civilians," the Russian president added.



Syria asked the UN Security Council to prevent a repeat of Israeli attacks.

September 3, 2021, 6:22 PM

Nevertheless, according to him, refugees are actively returning to the liberated areas, rebuilding their homes and starting a normal life.

In turn, the President of Syria stated that, through joint efforts, the countries had achieved success in the fight against terrorists.

"Our two armies, the Russian and Syrian, have achieved significant results not only in liberating occupied territories seized by militants and in eliminating terrorism, but also in facilitating the return of refugees who were forced to leave their homes and their homeland," the Syrian leader emphasized.

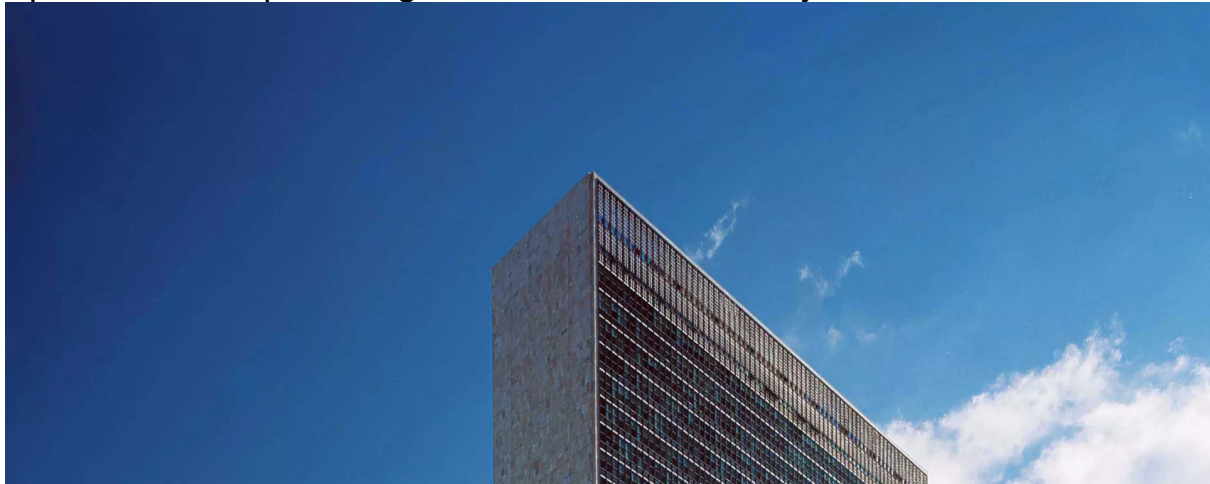
According to him, international terrorism "knows no borders" and "spreads like a contagion throughout the world." Assad also emphasized Russia's enormous contribution to protecting people from this evil.

The Russian president also noted that, through joint efforts, "the main, overwhelmingly large territory of the Syrian Republic has been liberated."

"The terrorists have suffered very serious, significant damage, and the Syrian government, led by you, controls 90% of the territory," Putin said.

During the meeting, the parties discussed the supply of coronavirus vaccines to Syria. Specifically, they discussed the Sputnik V and Sputnik Light vaccines.

"We are working together to address the main challenge facing all of humanity today—the fight against the coronavirus. The first deliveries of Sputnik V and Sputnik Light have been made to Syria," Putin said.



Iran's representative demanded the withdrawal of all uninvited forces from Syria.

August 25, 2021, 2:23 PM

The parties also discussed the issue of sanctions imposed against Damascus.

"Some states have imposed sanctions on the Syrian people that can be classified and positioned as anti-human, anti-state, and illegitimate," the Syrian president lamented.

According to Assad, "there are certain states that in every possible way destructively influence the possibility of conducting political processes."

However, according to him, the country's authorities are trying to establish political dialogue or other processes "in the conditions and environment that have developed at the present time."